

Purpose:

Players learn to come under control, get in athletic position and stay wide and balanced when fielding the ball.

Setup:

Players form one or more lines. Two cones are placed close together about 10-20 feet in front of each line.

Instructions:

1. When the drill starts, the first player in each line runs to the cones, where they decelerate and get into good fielding position with their feet on the outside of the cones.
2. The player holds the position for a second and then leaves and the next player in line goes.



Players learn to stay balanced when fielding.

Coaching Tips:

- When players reach the cones and get into fielding position they should imagine a triangle with the sides running from their feet to a point in front of them. That point is where their glove goes to field the ball.

- When running, the players should not have their throwing hands in their gloves as this will slow them down.
- Teach players the importance of approaching the cones at a speed that allows them to effectively decelerate, finding a balance between speed and control.
- Emphasize maintaining a low, balanced posture when getting into the fielding position, with knees bent and torso slightly leaned forward.
- Instruct players on the correct positioning of the glove, ensuring it is out in front, open, and ready to field the ball, aligning with the imaginary triangle's point.

For Younger Athletes:

- Focus on teaching the basic fielding stance, including how to position feet, bend knees, and place gloves.
- Make the drill fun to keep younger players engaged, such as turning it into a game or competition for the best fielding position.
- Use simple, clear instructions and demonstrations, as younger players often benefit from visual examples for proper execution.

For Older Athletes:

- Challenge older players to transition efficiently from running to fielding, including quick deceleration and immediate readiness to field.
- Incorporate agility exercises into the drill, enhancing players' ability to adjust their footwork quickly for proper fielding position.
- Simulate game-like conditions by varying the drill, such as having a coach roll or hit the ball towards the player as they reach the fielding position.